

Ticking closer to deal on TikTok

Trump says China's president approves the planned takeover of the app in the U.S.

By Wendy Lee

President Trump said Friday that he has reached a deal with China to keep the popular social video app TikTok running in the U.S.

Trump said on his social media platform that he had a "very productive call" Friday morning with China's President Xi Jinping. TikTok is owned by Chinese tech company ByteDance, a fact that prompted U.S. national security concerns over data protection.

He suggested that Xi had approved the planned takeover of TikTok in the U.S. but did not provide details on what the leader's sign-off entailed.

"We made progress on many very important issues including Trade, Fentanyl, the need to bring the War between Russia and Ukraine to an end, and the approval of the 'TikTok Deal,'" Trump wrote Friday.

He added: "The call was a very good one, we will be speaking again by phone, appreciate the TikTok approval, and both look forward to meeting at APEC!"

Trump had signaled earlier this week that an agreement was coming. For months, TikTok's future had been uncertain in the U.S., due to the national security worries. Trump in his social media post did not reveal much detail about the deal but said this week that TikTok's U.S. operations would be owned by American investors.

"TikTok has tremendous value," Trump said at a news conference Thursday, adding that the U.S. will be getting a "fee-plus" for making the deal. "I'd rather reap the benefits. The kind of money we are talking about is very substantial. It will be owned by all American investors."

The Wall Street Journal reported Tuesday that under terms of the deal, TikTok's U.S. users would migrate to a new version of the app with technology licensed from ByteDance. U.S. user data would be managed in Texas by cloud

[See TikTok, A12]



WILLIAM LIANG For The Times

MUDSLIDES BRING MISERY

A WOMAN watches as workers clean debris from mudslides triggered by downpours in Forest Falls. A toddler who was riding in a car with his father when it was swept away remains missing. CALIFORNIA, B1

Jockeying for first in moon race

The U.S. and China are sprinting toward manned missions to the lunar surface by decade's end, with sights set on 2029

By Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — Early in his first term, President Trump held a modest ceremony directing NASA to return humans to the moon for the first time in 50 years. It was a goalpost set without a road map. Veterans of the space community reflected on the 2017 document, conspicuously silent on budgets and timelines, equivocating between excitement and concern.

Was Trump setting up a giveaway to special interests in the aerospace community? Or was he setting forth a



Visual China Group

CHINA has conducted tests seen as vital for a moon trip. Above, a Chinese rocket with satellites lifts off.

real strategic vision for the coming decade, to secure American leadership in the heavens?

It was a return to a plan first proposed by President George W. Bush in 2004, then abandoned by President Obama in 2010, asserting the moon as a vital part of American ambitions in space. Whether to return to the lunar surface at all — or skip it to focus on Mars — was a long-standing debate governing the division of resources at NASA, where every project is precious, holding extraordinary promise for the knowledge of

[See Moon, A6]

UCLA enacts campus protest rules

New policies further limit some areas but expand on free speech zones

By Jaweed Kaleem

As UCLA grapples with sweeping government attacks on its research funding and policies, the university on Friday released new campus protest rules — several in sync with Trump adminis-

tration demands to crack down on demonstrators — but others that expand free speech zones and allow activities the White House wants to prohibit.

The guidelines formalize interim policies put in place last September, when UCLA and UC issued strict man-

dates banning unauthorized overnight encampments and the use of masks while breaking campus policy. Most of UCLA's outdoor spaces were off-limits to any protest that was not pre-approved, which remains the case.

The policies were an-

nounced ahead of the Monday kickoff of the fall term and come at a high-pressure moment as U.S. universities reevaluate safety and come under pressure from conservatives to take action against comments they consider insensitive about the

[See UCLA, A14]

PANEL CURBS COVID-19 VACCINE RULES

At a chaotic hearing, key CDC committee also delays action on hepatitis B shots.

By Corinne Purtill and Jenny Gold

After a contentious discussion that at times referenced discredited theories, low-quality data and desperate pleas from physicians and patients to rely upon sound science, a key CDC committee opted Friday to weaken its existing recommendations on COVID-19 shots, while punting other vaccine decisions to a later date.

The Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices voted unanimously to pull back its current unequivocal recommendation that all adults get vaccinated against COVID-19 in favor of a process of "shared clinical decision making," in which patients are encouraged to speak to a doctor, nurse or pharmacist first.

The group came extremely close to recommending that the COVID-19 vaccine be available by prescription only, with a 6-6 vote broken by chair Martin Kulldorff's "no" vote. The group also postponed a vote on hepatitis B vaccination indefinitely, with some members arguing that a proposal to delay the first dose did not go far enough.

The two-day meeting's chaotic atmosphere left even many close observers confused about what decisions the group actually made.

"What we're seeing is what happens when individuals who don't have a basic understanding about how vaccines are delivered are making these crucial policy decisions for the American public. They don't know what they're doing," Dr. Sean O'Leary, chair of American Academy of Pediatrics' Committee on Infectious Diseases, said Friday during a news conference over Zoom. "What we are getting from ACIP is confusion."

[See Shots, A9]



DENNIS UTT

CRITICS say airspace limits threaten the King of the Hammers off-road race.

Pentagon plan pits Marines against off-roaders and pilots

By Alex Wigglesworth

LUCERNE VALLEY, Calif. — The U.S. Marine Corps tried once to occupy this remote stretch of California desert beloved by off-roaders — but officials managed eventually to broker a deal that allowed both leathernecks and dirt riders to share the same rocky canyons and wrinkled mountains of Johnson Valley.

Now, more than a decade later, the Marines are back — and this time, they want the skies.

The Pentagon has proposed restricting civilian air traffic above much of the Johnson Valley Off-Highway Vehicle Area to expand and support training exercises. But those who frequent the area just west of the Twenty-nine Palms Marine base say the proposal would severely limit recreational access and

reduce safety.

They say the airspace restrictions could prevent rescue helicopters from evacuating injured motorists, and threaten the famed King of the Hammers off-road race that's held there each year.

And perhaps most crucially, they fear the proposal — which must be approved by the Federal Aviation Administration — is just the first step toward the Marines

[See Marines, A14]

\$2.6-billion Convention Center expansion OKd despite fiscal risks

By David Zahniser and Noah Goldberg

L.A. political leaders on Friday took what their own policy experts called a risky bet, agreeing to pour billions of dollars into the city's aging Convention Center in the hope that it will breathe new life into a struggling downtown and the region's economy.

In an 11-2 vote, the City Council approved a \$2.6-billion expansion of the Los Angeles Convention Center, despite warnings from their own advisors that the project will draw taxpayer funds away from essential city services for decades to come.

The risks don't stop there. If the Convention Center expansion experiences major construction

delays, the project's first phase may not be finished in time for the 2028 Olympic and Paralympic Games, when the facility is set to host judo, gymnastics and other competitions.

That, in turn, could leave the city vulnerable to financial penalties from the committee organizing the event, according to the city's policy analysts.

[See Convention, A7]

N.Y. Times suit by Trump tossed

Federal judge rules that defamation case is full of "tedious and burdensome" language with no relevance. NATION, A5

Screenwriters, Eisner rip Disney

WGA members and ex-CEO join criticism against the move to bench Jimmy Kimmel. BUSINESS, A10

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 85/66. B8



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ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

UC POLICE TO GET ARSENAL

Campuses including UC Irvine, shown last year, requested more weapons. Rifle rounds, drones and pepper balls will be purchased. CALIFORNIA, B1